Betrayed by members of his own village. Too canny and cautious to stay overnight in his own home, Jameel would always stay in safe houses in various neighbouring villages. Nobody knew where he would be. We could never contact him—he would contact us. Even his buddy Farooq would not know where he would be spending the night. But fate had caught up with him and he had been betrayed.

A few days later, I went to pay my condolences. Before entering the village, which had been secured by my protection party, I stopped for a few moments beside a fresh grave, with an iron grill around it, painted green. Inside, a small headstone gave the essential details. Ghulam Qadir Bhat, born . . . died . . . just the essential details. Ghulam Qadir Bhat. Though we had met often following that first meeting, I had never asked him his name. Nor had he ever volunteered the information. He was just Jameel to one and all. Another foot soldier in the war against terrorism. But Ghulam Qadir Bhat was a person, with parents, brothers, sisters. All of a sudden, I dreaded the idea of going into the village and facing his family members. What would I say to them?

Our arrival outside Jameel's house brought on a crowd of onlookers. Curious housewives, excited children always on the lookout for something to break their dreary routine, and sullen, suspicious men who eyed us from a safe distance. We sat outside in the pale morning sun. I offered my condolences through my interpreter, Manzoor, a Subedar from the JAK LI. I looked at each one of them. Jameel's frail mother, crying inconsolably; his aged father, gazing around incomprehensibly in a state of shock, puffing away on his hookah; two sisters, young and unmarried; a younger brother, Bashir, who would now have to take over the responsibility that had been Jameel's, but he did not have the same confidence. Here was a family that had

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